

Maria Alexis Sales

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Summary

Backend software engineer with 4+ years of experience across game development, enterprise platforms, and AI infrastructure. Strong background in CI/CD automation, API design, and distributed systems tooling; proficient in strongly-typed languages and cloud-native environments. Open to relocation to the UK.

Education and Certifications

Stanford University and DeepLearning.ai – Machine Learning Specialization	2023
University of Illinois at Chicago – Minor in Computer Science; B.A. in Music Performance	2021

Experience

Software Engineer , USG Corporation – Hybrid	Sept 2025 – Present
- Contributed to the launch of the redesigned USG website (Dec 2025) by optimizing a multi-stage product data pipeline, reducing Kafka message bloat, authoring cleanup scripts to purge stale Algolia records after TTL expiry, and improving pipeline observability through structured logging across the PostgreSQL → Kafka → Algolia flow, as part of a broader Next.js 15 migration. - Refined end-to-end product data flow from a NestJS backend to a TypeScript/React/Next.js frontend to support locale-specific rendering, ensuring each market received only the relevant subset of product attributes based on the user's region. - Instrumented product listing, product detail, and file library pages with Adobe Analytics event tracking using client-side data, providing business analytics with granular visibility into user interactions across the product catalog.	
Software Engineer – AI Expert Contributor , Snorkel AI – Remote	June 2024 – Present
- Reviewed and validated AI-generated software engineering tasks derived from real open-source PRs, assessing correctness of problem statements, test cases, and solution artifacts against source material. - Evaluated task quality for a coding agent benchmark dataset (Harbor format), verifying Docker-based execution environments, test harnesses, and verifier reward logic to ensure tasks met difficulty and language distribution targets.	
Software Developer I , Pacific Life – Newport Beach, CA	Sept 2024 – Nov 2024
- Designed a C# API to ingest policyholder notification events, including policy updates and coverage changes, publishing messages to Kafka for real-time logging and delivery to policyholders and plan administrators. - Migrated legacy MuleSoft integrations to AWS Lambda and API Gateway to modernize the notification pipeline and support scalable third-party vendor access to policyholder data, eliminating processing bottlenecks by distributing Lambda execution across US East, West, and Central regions with S3-triggered load balancing to enable concurrent file processing at scale. - Built the document upload API in C# to route validated policyholder records to the correct insurance tier (broad vs. affluent), completing the end-to-end flow from notification event to insurer delivery.	
Associate Software Engineer , Blizzard Entertainment – Irvine, CA	Oct 2022 – Sept 2024
- Improved LiveOps workflows across Diablo II: Resurrected and Diablo III through automation and internal tooling, reducing friction in the dev cycle and contributing to a player experience serving 50k+ CCU monthly. - Built two core developer tools: a binary validation utility that compared local environment binaries against Artifactory hashes to catch environment drift, and a crash reporting pipeline migrated from Python to C# to natively interface with console SDKs (Nintendo, Sony, Xbox) and eliminate brittle cross-language workarounds. - Provided on-call support during live patch cycles for Diablo II: Resurrected (a 20+ year old C++ codebase), coordinating hotfixes, rollbacks, and cross-team triage to maintain stability for an active player base.	